

Ellis Island Experience

Years of Operation: 1892-1954

Directions: Watch the video: [Immigrants at Ellis Island | History](#) (4:28) to answer the questions below about the process immigrants experienced when they went through Ellis Island.

To complete the assignment, you may have to pause and/or return to the video multiple times. I also recommend turning on closed captioning. It's only 4:28, and it goes really quickly.



For more information, check out: [A Virtual Field Trip to Ellis Island](#)

Intro

1. What year did Ellis Island open?
2. Why was it built? What was it needed for?
3. By its closing in **1954**, how many immigrants were processed through Ellis Island?

The Voyage

4. How did people from Europe travel to the United States? Be specific.
5. How long did it take?
6. Who traveled in steerage? How much did it cost? What was steerage like?

Arrival

7. What happened first before anyone got off the ship once it arrived in New York Harbor?

8. Did first- and second-class passengers go through Ellis Island? Why do you think this was the case?
9. Once getting off the ship from the ferry, what was the first thing a third-class passenger did?

Medical Exam

10. What was the purpose of having people walk up the stairs? Describe the Medical Exam.

Legal Inspection

11. Describe the Legal Inspection. Why would people be detained?

-Did most people pass the legal inspection?

12. Were many people detained?

Entering America

13. What were the three aisles on the stairs for?

14. What was at the end of the stairs? (3 things that immigrants may need)

15. How long do you think it took to process most people through Ellis Island? (Take an educated guess and we will talk about it in class)

Ending Question

16. Summarize in your own words what the experience was like for immigrants at Ellis Island. Include at least three pieces of evidence.